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October 17, 2026

The Editors
BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making

Submission of a research article: "TRACER-Med: differentially private evidential learning with prototype alignment and conformal prediction for clinical risk prediction"

Dear Editors,

I submit the above manuscript as a research article for consideration in *BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making*.

Why this journal. The manuscript concerns machine-learning methods for clinical decision support, which is within the scope of the journal. It evaluates a framework that combines differentially private training, a fairness-oriented alignment term, private conformal calibration, and uncertainty-aware attribution, on four cohorts (one real hospital cohort of 20,000 patients, two small public clinical benchmarks, and one simulated cohort), with an exact privacy accountant, a noise-multiplier sweep, ablations, and comparisons with DPSGD-F and an adaptation of PF-LD. The main findings are mixed and are reported as such: the framework gives better calibration on the larger cohorts under differential privacy, but it does not improve equalized-odds disparity relative to the private baselines, its subgroup-calibrated clipping shows no consistent benefit, and its private conformal layer is uninformative on small cohorts. The manuscript also reports a numerical audit of its analytical statements and the corrections it led to. Because the journal assesses scientific validity and not perceived impact, I believe it is a suitable venue for a study whose contribution is a carefully evaluated and fully reproducible set of results, including negative ones.

Issues relating to journal policies. All data are publicly available and de-identified, or synthetic, and no ethics approval was required. The Pima Indians Diabetes data originate from an Indigenous community, and the manuscript states the related data-governance considerations. All code, result files, and numerical checks are available, and the result files are included as additional files. The manuscript contains a statement on the use of generative AI tools.

Competing interests. I declare no competing interests.

Authorship and originality. I am the sole author and I approve the manuscript for submission. The content has not been published and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere.

Sincerely,

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